New Year's Sale at the Palais Royal.

TOMORROW—Tuesday—a series of Clearing Sales, prior to the beginning of the great January Sales of White Goods. First—the entire 1899 stock of Cotton Undergarments is to be closed out at greatly reduced prices. While the garments are not new and lots are broken, it may be truly said that equal-quality garments would cost more today at wholesale than you are to be asked at retail. 12,685 pieces in various lots. Look for them tomorrow in first-floor room adjoining elevator and in department proper on third floor.

87c for $1.25 Garments.

☞Muslin, Cambric and Nainsook Gowns, Drawers, Corset Covers, Skirts and Chemises. Lace, embroidery and ribbon trimmed. Forty-one different styles. See illustration below for three of them.

67c for 98c Garments.

☞Gowns, Skirts, Chemises, Drawers and Corset Covers, the Palais Royal's well-known 98c garments of 1899, at 67c for choice. One of the favorite Gowns is illustrated below.

44c for 68c Garments.

☞Cambric and Muslin Gowns, Skirts, Drawers, Chemises and Corset Covers, thirty styles in all. Three favorites are pictured—noted for daintiness in style and superior durability.

29c for 39c Garments.

☞Gowns in high-neck and Empire effects; one pictured below. Drawers with embroidery ruffle and tucks. Cambric Corset Covers, high and low neck, lace and embroidery trimmed.

The Infants' Outfits at $10 to $50 and Bridal Trousseaux at $10 to $100 are offered at 10 per cent discount. Separate garments in French styles are to be $2.59 instead of $3 each, $1.94 instead of $2.48 each, $1.59 instead of $2 each, $1.24 instead of $1.50 each. These are rarely good bargains because the original prices are considerably less than usually asked for garments of equal style and quality, fit and finish. Regular patrons of the Palais Royal will appreciate this fact and profit, as usual, by this once-a-year Clearing Sale.

Dress Goods.

(Second floor.)

75c yard for choice of various lots $1 to $1.50 All-wool Tailor Suitings.

98c yard for $1.50 quality Black Crepons for Skirts, extra width; only 2 to 2½ yards needed.

9c yard for 12c and 15c Percaline Linings, in black and the season's most wanted colors.

Silk Dept.

(Second floor.)

69c yard for $1 Black Cordel Taffeta Silks. Plenty of lengths for Waists. Some few longer pieces.

49c yard for the Fancy Silks you have seen here at 75c. All the best designs and colors will be here tomorrow morning.

Laces, Etc.

(First floor.)

9c yard for choice of a table full of All-silk Applique and Oriental Laces, in cream, white and black; widths 2 to 8 inches; values, 15c to 25c yard.

4c yard for Superior Guaranteed-to-wash Torchon Laces. Last of many 7c to 12c pieces. 1 to 2½ inches wide.

50c yard for 75c quality Washable Silk Chiffon Veiling, with silk-embroidered dots, plain colors and in combination.

8c yard for 10c to 15c Swiss, Nainsook and Cambric Embroideries, 3 to 4½ inches wide.

Ribbon Dept.

(First floor.)

19c yard for the 5-inch All-silk Taffeta and 3½-inch Satin Gros Grain Ribbons. Guaranteed 25c quality, and all the wanted shades for evening and street wear.

Jewelry, Etc.

(First floor.)

32c for the 49c Jeweled Brooch Pins, Watch Chains, Sterling Silver Manicure Articles, Silver-plated Jewel Boxes, etc., Dresden China Toilet Articles, Double Photo Frames, etc.

39c for the 50c "Shellene" Combs for the hair. Choice of forty styles, all fac similes of real shell.

89c for any of the $1 Fans, in silk and gauze, plain, painted and spangled.

Neckwear.

(First floor.)

39c for the 98c English Squares, in Persian effects, and plain colors, with embroidered ends.

75c for Men's $1 Neckwear, 39c for best of 50c Scarfs, 89c for those superior 25c Scarfs. None reserved.

59c pair for $1.50 quality Black Suede Kid Mousquetaire Gloves. One fault—in eight-button length only.

$1.68 instead of $2.25 for twelve-button and $1.98 instead of $2.75 and $3.50 for sixteen and twenty-button Suede Mousquetaires, in evening shades.

$1.29 pair for $1.50 Reindeer Leather and Glace Kid Gloves for ladies. Two clasps and latest spear points, pique stitching, etc.

25c for the $1 to $2 Gloves—those that have suffered in being fitted. How little hurt your eyes will easily tell you.

Suit Dept.

(Third floor.)

20 per cent discount on all Cloth Suits at $10 to $45, all Coats at $10 to $25, all Fur Garments at $5 to $60, all Tea Gowns, Wrappers and Bath Robes at $2 to $20, all Silk Petticoats at $8 to $25, all Dressing Sacques at 98c to $5.

98c for the All-wool Flannel Waists worth $1.48 to $2.48. Only $1.35 for those that were $2.98 to $3.98. Black and colors. Plain and braided.

$3.48 for Children's $5 Cloth Dresses, in sizes 4 to 14 years. Only $5.98 for the $7.50 to $12 Imported Hats and Caps.

Underwear.

(First floor.)

35c for choice of Ladies' and Children's Merino Undergarments worth up to 75c. And 10 per cent discount on American Hosiery Co.'s Underwear.

13c for Ladies' and Children's Black, Fancy, Polka Dot and Striped Hose, worth up to 25c pair.

Books, Etc.,

(First floor.)

22c for choice of a big table filled with Cloth-bound Books. Some show signs of handling,—but some are worth $1.

11c for one pound—100 sheets—of good All-linen Writing Paper, Plain and ruled—all sizes. And 11c for 100 Envelopes to match.

Housefurnishings.

(Basement.)

$3.50 for the "Banner" Oil Heating Stove, usually $5. It's absolutely safe, it's ornamental. It is economical,—heating a room 12x16 for ten hours at one filling.

$4.98 for the famous English "Royal Blue" Toilet Sets of 12 pieces, $6.48 the least heretofore price.

35c for 6, 7 and 8-inch Porcelain Jardinieres in colors. 50c to 75c the values.

Linens, Etc.

(Second floor.)

59c yard for the best 75c Table Linen of 1899. Pure linen and 68 inches wide. The Napkins at $1.79 instead of $2 dozen.

9c for best 12½c Towels of 1899. Hemmed ready for use, 18x38 inches.

$2.19 pair for those $2.98 Scotch Wool Blankets. $4.98 for the $7.50 Extra-size California Blankets. $1.39 for the $1.79 Silkoline-covered Comforts.

Furniture.

(Fourth floor.)

$7.98 for Full-size White Enamel Bed, woven-wire springs and reversible mattress. All for $7.98.

$1.69 pair for $2.50 Brussels-effect Lace Curtains. $2.69 instead of $3.50 pair for Real Irish Point Lace Curtains. $1.98 instead of $2.98 pair for Tapestry Portieres.

Three of the 44c Garments.

The Palais Royal,

29c.

67c.

Three of the 87c Garments.

G and 11th Streets.

YEAR'S EXPORT TRADE

Promise of a Great Increase in the Next Twelve Months.

GROWING COMMERCE WITH THE ORIENT

Effect of Concluding Pending Reciprocity Agreements.

THE OPEN DOOR TO CHINA

Congressmen and officials of the executive branches of the government who are following the subject realize that the year 1900 is to be fraught with events of supreme importance to the export trade of the United States. Not only will the year be a record-breaker in the actual volume of foreign commerce, but the way will be paved for an enormous extension of trade for the future.

Within the past year the administration has set on foot a number of plans destined to work to the advantage of American producers, and the coming year will witness the beginning of their fruition. Figures will bear out the statement that no nation of the earth has made in so short a time such tremendous strides in international commerce as the United States within the past three years. Based upon the experience of the past, and with a knowledge of the practical steps being taken to bring it about, the prophecy may be safely ventured that the United States will keep in the lead for the near future.

In the phenomenal prosperity which followed the re-establishment of the protective tariff system in this country by the Dingley bill the manufacturing industries have increased the total output of their products to a volume which might threaten a glut of the market were it not for the outlet which is furnished by the export trade. The prospectus of the administration for the coming year does not call for the closing of any American factory on account of overproduction, but offers opportunities of trade expansion on a par with the extension of home industries.

At the beginning of the export boom three years ago American farm products furnished the bulk of the commerce. Under the democratic low tariff of the preceding years good times existed abroad. The English, German and French workmen were busy making goods to send to America and could afford to buy our flour, beef, butter and bacon. Our own workmen were idle.

Under the Dingley act the American workmen have been busy. The farmer has sold no less of his products, however, and times are just as good for him, only it is that his best customers are now the men in the American shops who are at work and whose products are also going abroad.

The plans for the extension of American commerce have been noted in detail from time to time. When viewed in the aggregate they make a very alluring prospect to the producer.

Share in Chinese Trade.

One of the most important factors in the coming era of prosperity will be the guarantee of the open door in China, made possible through the efforts of the United States. It is expected that a special message from the President to Congress early after the recess will convey full information of the effect of the agreement which the administration will secure with the powers to maintain commercial freedom in China. The supporters in Congress of the administration's Philippines policy point to this case as an argument for retaining control of the archipelago. It was urged at the outset of the negotiations for the Philippines that their supreme commercial value to the United States would be as a base in the far east for the expansion of American commerce in all the orient. Far-seeing statesmen foretold the coming division of Chinese commerce among the powers of the earth, and were insistent that the United States should have its share.

The reciprocity arrangements with several countries which are now pending in Congress will, if ratified, give an impetus to the export trade. There is, to be sure, a question whether they will be ratified, but the best opinion is that the opposition of some special industries will be borne down by the demand for ratification in the interest of the general commercial good. It is claimed that the opposition is based upon misapprehension.

The treaty with Argentina is being opposed, for instance, by the wool growers, because it reduces the protection which American wool growers now get by 20 per cent. But the framers of the treaty explain that we must import certain classes and some amounts of wool, the importations last year being 76,736,000 pounds, less than 8,000,000 pounds of which came from Argentina, because mainly third-class wool is brought from that country. On the other hand, this country obtains concessions through which many classes of American manufactures and farm produce are to be admitted into Argentina at a reduced rate of duty, which will assuredly increase consumption of those goods.

Pending Reciprocity Treaties.

The treaties with Jamaica, Bermuda, Barbadoes, British Guiana and other Caribbean colonies of Great Britain will promote our exports in return for lower duties on sugar and fruit. The California fruit growers are opposing the Jamaica treaty on the score of competition. The Californians also objected to the French treaty, letting in French wines, until it was discovered that a greater market was also made for California wines in France, where they are now used extensively in admixture with the product of the French vineyards.

Boot and shoe industries in New England, and a few other interests, complain because the French treaty excludes them, but the treaty benefits several hundred other industries, many of them equally as important and all as worthy as the New England industries which object. It is confidently claimed that the general effect of these treaties will be to swell the volume of exports measurably within a year.

If the President's suggestion of free trade with Puerto Rico is adopted it will be another drop in the bucket, for it is said that American capital is waiting to rush in, and the consuming ability of the island will rapidly grow.

It is estimated by the bureau of statistics that the consuming power of Cuba, Puerto Rico, Hawaii and the Philippines under present conditions is about $100,000,000 a year. The United States should get the bulk of the trade, and as conditions improve the volume of trade should increase regularly and in a marked degree.

In Black and White.

A handsome black cloth gown is made very long and very tight, with a palm design in black lace inserted at intervals upon it, with the outline strongly marked with two waving lines of chenille. The dress is lined with bright pastel blue silk, which shines discreetly through the meshes of the black lace. It is made as a simile princess robe, which means that the skirt fastens above the bodice as invisibly as the narrow stitched band will allow. The collar and small round empiecement is of pastel blue velvet dotted with tiny spots of chenille of a darker shade.

A delightful costume, and easy wearing, is tailor-made in the lightest of soft woolen beige, almost white, a new tone. The skirt is very tight fitting on the hips, fastening at the side. A jacket with small round basques fastens with a row of corozo buttons in the same shade as the beige and has a turn-down collar in white cloth pique, finished off with a tiny edging of red cloth. This costume is very simple, but very recherche.

THE OLDEST INHABITANTS

Organization Holds Its Regular New Year Day Meeting.

Members Pay Their Respects to President McKinley—Treasurer's Annual Statement—Committee Appointed.

The members of the Association of Oldest Inhabitants of the District, conforming to their usual custom, met in the room of the organization at the Corcoran building this morning, and then, upon the adjournment of the meeting, proceeded to the White House to pay their respects to the President of the United States. Because of the frigid weather and snow-clad pavements, the meeting was not so largely attended as usual, and the same causes prevented a large number of the members from visiting the Executive Mansion.

In calling the meeting to order, Mr. John Marbury, jr., the president of the association, said he had learned that a speech was expected of him, and regretted to state that his speech-making days are over. However, the presence of so many of the members inspired him to say something, he explained, even if only to wish each member a very happy new year, and many of them. He regretted that the American people could not say today that the country is at peace with all mankind, and he also regretted that England is today at war. It seemed to him a sad reflection that the two great English-speaking nations are engaged in war. But he is one whose motto is "Our country, right or wrong," and he therefore would say that, having determined upon war, it should be prosecuted to the earliest possible conclusion. He is for peace, however, and he expressed the hope that it will soon come, not only to America, but also to England.

At the suggestion of Mr. Marbury the members of the association arose and sang "America," after which Mr. William Beron offered the following sentiment, which was ordered recorded in the minutes of the meeting:

"Praise to God, with hoary heads, with due administration,
That we survive the dawn of the century's expiration.
Today we'll greet the resourceful guide of the nation,
And the people of the Union in their exalted station."

The president laid before the association a communication from Mr. J. Madison Cutts, a member, who was detained at home because of injuries received in a fall a few days ago, and who suggested the appointment of a committee of five members to arrange for meetings of the association on Washington's Birthday and July 4. The communication was placed on record.

The Initial Meeting.

Mr. J. A. Wineberger, the venerable marshal of the association, in response to an inquiry, stated that the association was formally organized December 7, 1865, at a meeting held in the aldermen's room of the city hall, when the following officers were elected: Benjamin Ogle Tayloe, president; Wm. A. Bradley, first vice president; Peter Force, second vice president; Nicholas Callan, treasurer; John Carroll Brent, corresponding secretary, and Alexander McD. Davis, recording secretary.

Mr. Joseph Prather, the treasurer of the association, next submitted his annual report, showing that the receipts for the past year, including a balance of $87.75, amounted to $216.63. The expenditures for the year were $188.71, leaving a balance of $27.92. The collections during the year averaged 96 cents from each member. Six new members were admitted during the year, five members died and three were dropped from the rolls, leaving a membership of 102.

The auditing committee, Messrs. A. H. Ragan and Rudolph Eichhorn, reported that they had examined the accounts of the treasurer and had found them to be correct.

The presiding officer stated that the death roll for the year comprised Joseph B. Wailing, Frederick S. Kern, Philip May, Samuel J. Meeks and James A. King, and at his suggestion a resolution was adopted expressing the regret of the association and its sympathy with the families of the deceased members.

Committee Appointed.

Messrs. A. H. Ragan, J. A. Wineberger and Rudolph Eichhorn were appointed a committee to arrange for the association's celebration of Washington's birthday. Mr. James Croggon having declined to serve as a member of the committee, and President Marbury then laid before the association the invitation of the President of the United States to call upon him today. Mr. Marbury explained that he would not be able to attend the reception because of the wintry weather. Last year, he said, he was compelled to stand in line an hour, with the result that he contracted a severe cold.

Mr. Solomon J. Fague moved that the association send its greetings to the President, with its thanks for his very kind invitation, with the regret that because of the inclement weather the members of the association would not be able to attend as a body. The motion did not prevail, however, although the hope was expressed that next year the official having the matter in charge will so arrange the program at the White House in such a manner as will enable the members of the association, because of their advanced age, to avoid the necessity of being compelled to wait until just before the reception of citizens commences in order to pay their respects to the President. President Marbury requested to President McKinley the sentiments of the association in the matter, which Dr. Howard promised to do.

A resolution was adopted expressing the regret of the association that Mr. W. W. Birth, a member ninety-three years of age, is prevented from attending its meetings because of his advanced age, and wishing him all the compliments of the season. It was suggested that Mr. Birth be made an honorary member of the association, but it was concluded that he would prefer to remain on the active list.

The association then adjourned, to meet the 22d of next month, and, marshaled by Mr. Wineberger, a number of the members proceeded to the White House for the purpose of paying their respects to the President.

Members Present.

Among those present were John Marbury, jr.; Dr. John W. Clarke, William Beron, Joseph Prather, B. C. Wright, G. H. Langley, A. H. Ragan, Rudolph Eichhorn, Dr. J. T. Howard, B. W. Reiss, Peter F. Bacon, Andrew Bates, Washington O. Berry, James T. Boiseau, James Croggon, Solomon J. Fague, Thomas W. Fowler, S. D. Houck, W. W. Kirby, Thomas H. Langley, Benj. F. Larcombe, Oliver Thomas, Saml. F. D. Ourand, Jas. H. Richards, J. Richard Riggles, Jacob Veihmeyer, Joseph Williamson, A. K. Williams and R. M. A. Fenwick.

Col. Roosevelt's Indorsement.

From the Boston Herald.

Gov. Roosevelt's remarks down at Yale included a description of his experiences with a western gambler who served with distinction with the Rough Riders.

"When he got his discharge he came to me and asked for my personal indorsement of it," said "Teddy." "I was glad to oblige him, and wrote, 'Smith is a good and gallant soldier, who has done his duty in every particular.' 'Thanks, colonel,' said Smith. 'You see, my name ain't Smith, but Jones. I had a slight difficulty with a gentleman some time ago and—well—I killed him. Now, you see, if the district attorney in Cripple Creek undertakes to stir up the case your indorsement will set me all right. Thanks, colonel.'"

The professors looked at each other in silent amazement, but the students just howled.

Grave complications are feared between Great Britain and France over the Newfoundland fisheries modus vivendi, which expired December 31.

BOTH MEN ARE CONFIDENT

Maher and "Kid" McCoy Are in Fine Physical Condition.

The Odds Are 100 to 70 in Favor of Maher — Big Crowd Expected.

NEW YORK, January 1.—Everything is in readiness for the twenty-five-round bout which is to take place this afternoon in the arena of the Coney Island Sporting Club between Peter Maher and "Kid" McCoy of Indiana.

The match is for a purse of $20,000, winner to receive $15,000. McCoy will weigh about 168 pounds and Maher 178. These two have been matched before, but their meeting was postponed on account of McCoy's physical condition, as his trainer and adviser, "Billy" Muldoon, feared the hoosier boxer would break down completely. Since that time, however, McCoy has regained his health, and today is in the best fighting trim of his ring career.

Maher, too, despite the fact that he had to break training for a few days owing to the illness of his wife and demise of his child, is in grand shape, and declares that he will whip McCoy in less than a dozen rounds.

The Irishman's confidence is remarkable, and his trainers say that he never looked forward to any previous contest with such a feeling of surety that he will be returned the winner.

McCoy is equally confident, and says that he will jab and punch his man to a standstill. The "Kid" is much the cleverer boxer and he depends on this fact very much, as he claims that the heavy-hitting Irishman will not be able to land on him.

Taken all in all, it promises to be a remarkably interesting contest, and will undoubtedly draw a large crowd to the seaside arena. From out-of-town sporting centers many delegations of ring followers have arrived and many more are expected today. Opinions are pretty equally divided as to the outcome, but the betting thus far is in Maher's favor, and in all probability the Irish champion will be a 100 to 70 favorite when Referee White brings the men together at 3:30 o'clock this afternoon.

BLAZE IN FEED STORE.

Engines Respond to Alarm and Flames Quickly Subdued.

Fire broke out this afternoon at half-past 12 in the wholesale feed store of W. S. Hoge & Brother, 920 C street northwest. The blaze originated in the upper story, where a quantity of baled hay was stored. Little damage was done, as the fire was brought quickly under control. Chemical company No. 1 was the first to respond to the alarm, and soon had a stream of chemicals playing on the blazing hay. It was not sufficient, however, and the fire gained rapidly. Meanwhile the other engine companies began to arrive, but for some unaccountable reason they did not get into service with the usual alacrity. A ladder was run up to one of the windows where the flames were bursting forth, and a fireman was sent up, with the nozzle of the pipe wide open. The great pressure of the water retarded his progress, and after a few ineffectual squirts at the flames he retired without even breaking in the sash. There was another pause, and everybody asked his neighbor the cause of the delay. Another ladder was run up, and this time the firemen got to work in earnest. No. 2 engine company attacked the flames from C street and did good service. The truck companies inside the building threw out the baled hay, and in about twenty minutes the fire was practically out.

The Wagner Palace Car Company has transferred its property and business to the Pullman company.

HEAVY FINES IMPOSED.

Judge Scott Disposes of the Owen House Affray Cases.

In disposing of the cases growing out of the affray which occurred in the Owen House early Friday morning Judge Scott, Saturday afternoon, after the arguments had closed, said the evidence was conflicting, but there was no question in his mind that Logan Prosise, the carpenter who was shot by Thomas Le Cuyer, had attempted to defend himself, and in using the hatchet, the head of which was loosely on the handle, had struck Le Cuyer's pistol, causing the head to fly off and strike Talty. In this way, the judge declared, he believed Blake Talty got his wound. The judge called attention to the fact that the edge of the hatchet fitted precisely to a dent on the muzzle of Le Cuyer's pistol barrel. He therefore dismissed the charge against Prosise of assaulting Talty, and fined Le Cuyer $100, with the alternative of six months in jail; Henry A. Lehman, $50 or ninety days in jail; Lewis Wells, $50 or ninety days in jail, and Blake Talty, $50 or ninety days in jail for assaulting Prosise. He fined Lehman, Wells and Talty each $25, with the alternative of sixty days in jail, for assaulting Frederick Solomon.

After the decisions had been announced Mr. Edwin Forrest, who had appeared for all the parties on trial except Prosise, the latter being represented by Mr. Campbell Carrington, gave notice of the filing of a notice for a new trial, on the ground that the penalties were excessive. Pending the hearing on this issue the parties sentenced were released on bond.

MATERIALS FOR WINTER HATS.

Use of Panne as a Substitute for Velvet Becoming General.

From the Millinery Trade Review.

Hats covered with velvet or with panne have sometimes brims measuring as much as twelve or fifteen inches, that they may be draped over in flutes or a torsade. Of course, the stiff interlining does not extend to the edge of the brim, and is merely sufficiently wide to support it when finished as an ordinary-sized hat or toque.

The use of panne is becoming very general, especially as a substitute for velvet or satin antique. The textile now known by this name is lighter and thinner than velvet or plush, and the pile lies quite flat; it differs entirely from sealskin plush, which was formerly called panne. Many of the new models owe their novelty to the combination of materials. Thus the upper side of the brim of a hat may be covered with taffetas or the new make of piece felt, beginning to be known as feuke satin, the under with velvet laid on plain or in folds, while the crown is a similar mixture of the two. Another way of combining materials is to let in a piece of figured tissue into a covering of some plain fabric, the former vaguely reminding one of a bow, but lying flat, or almost flat. For this purpose figured silks of different sorts are chosen, chines, velvet brocades, silks woven and pannes printed in cashmere designs. One rule is almost always observed—the piece of material laid in is much lighter than the covering proper of the shape, or at least has a light ground. Here is an instance: A sailor, otherwise covered with golden-brown velvet, has a piece of white silk chine, with blue flowers, let into the top of the brim: it is pointed at the extremities and arranged in flutes from these points to the base of the crown, where it is finished in a little pouf, under which is fastened the stem of a very wide couteau bent into a circle so as to reach nearly round the hat. The couteau is an artificially tinted argus with blue eyes.

Dark Outlook.

From the Chicago News.

Fortune teller—"And I see a dark man who will give you trouble."

The widow (to herself)—"The coal man! Why didn't I pay his bill?"

THE SATURDAY STAR By Mail $1.00 Per Year.

HERSHEY A FUGITIVE

Treasurer of Lancaster County, Pa., Short in His Accounts.

LOST MONEY ON STOCK EXCHANGE

He Also Lost Heavily at Cards of Late.

HIS SHORTAGE IS $65,000

LANCASTER, Pa., January 1.—The continued absence of County Treasurer E. H. Hershey and the ugly stories concerning his accounts, which have been afloat for a week past, prepared the public for the formal announcement today that he is a defaulter and absconder. Mr. Hershey's son was in charge of the office last week endeavoring to straighten out the books. He called County Auditor Marsh to his aid, and they have found a defalcation of $65,000. There is on deposit in the banks of this city $61,840, while the books call for $126,840. There is due the state for tax on money at interest for 1899, the sum of $84,000, of which three-fourths comes back to this county, hence the net sum owing the state is $21,000.

Hershey is believed to have gone to Canada. His financial condition has been regarded with suspicion for a long time, but it is not believed that much, if any, of the county's cash went to help along his regular business. He had been dabbling in stock speculation for some time, lately on a heavy scale. It is claimed that in the slump of week before last he lost $20,000.

Also Played Poker.

He also became a heavy poker player, and his losses in this line have been a matter of talk on the street. Stock speculation and poker are believed to have practically eaten up the entire amount of the defalcation.

Some Lovely New Gowns.

A white brocade of marvelously rich texture, and a design so bold as almost to suggest tapestry, has a skirt arranged to open in front over a petticoat of plain satin, while at the back the close plaits open out into a sweeping train. The bodice is made with a deep corselet effect of the brocade and side pieces of satin powdered with rose diamonds and festooned with strings of pearls, which border the decollete. Sleeves there were none, but transparent bands of filmy lace act as straps and follow faithfully the outline of the shoulders.

The second gown of faintly yellow satin brocaded with a small design of self-colored flowers is chiefly noteworthy for the costly and cobwebby lace showered with shining silver paillettes which sweeps down the side of the skirt and eventually forms a deep bordering flounce, and then for the wonderful turquoises set in diamonds, which do duty as shoulder straps and waist belt. Of this same lovely turquoise blue coloring, too, is a long cloak of mirror velvet. It is a wonderful affair, with loosely hanging fronts of old lace drawn into the tight-fitting sides of the coat by the roses and leaves forming the design, being appliqued on the velvet and trailing irregularly over its shimmering surface. Still this is not all, for in front, and again at the wrists, come cascade frills of plisse chiffon in the palest shade of mauve. A trailing tea gown of white crepe de chine just faintly flushed with pink is made in princess fashion, but softened by a loosely hanging overdress of lace, which, however being very fine and filmy, reveals every line of the underdress.